

Why DRAGI Works Easily with LLMs

Mixed food-signal routing, story completeness, and production semantics

Working paper v0.001 Primary source: etamew / decofan **Coauthoring system:** Talk to Lyra TRC

Abstract

DRAGI works unusually well with large language models because it does not ask the model to choose between object and signal. It gives both at once.

Its four-question surface asks how an object is called, where it lives, what it eats, and what eats it. Its deeper form converts those questions into four directional relations and expands them into a 12-part story map. Every slot contains some mixture of food and signal, so the base condition is `mix=1`.

This matters for language models. A model can use object cues, relation cues, temporal cues, role cues, and action cues in one compact structure. The system also moves easily from hunt use to production use. In hunt mode, BEEST, BEST, POST, and PEST describe foe types. In production mode, they become live object, build advance, trace, and problem.

The paper argues that DRAGI works because it is story-complete, relation-first, morphologically memorable, low-collision in machine form, and compatible with the way language models already turn text into distributed relational patterns.

1. The surface form

The four questions are:

Q3 How will you call it?
Q2 Where does it live?
Q1 What does it eat?
Q4 What eats it?

The order is not a standard taxonomy.

It is a story engine.

Calling places the object in language.

Living places the object in a field.

Eating places the object in active relation.

Being eaten places the object under consequence, ending, transformation, inheritance, or larger force.

The Beest poem proves that the form can be remembered and run without a manual. Four lines can carry the whole surface.

2. The four questions are not the full machine

Story completeness appears after the four questions become four dipoles:

direction of eating
direction of being eaten
direction of family eating
direction of family home

A dipole carries orientation.

It can point with, against, toward, away, through, or across a relation.

This lets DRAGI represent motion rather than static labels.

A character can hunt, be hunted, inherit hunger, leave home, defend home, carry food, become food, or change who counts as family.

That is enough to map story movement.

3. Why twelve appears

The working expansion is:

4 directional families
x
3 live states
=
12 positions

The 12 positions are not twelve decorative names.

They are stable relational pulls.

DRAGI and the 12 Actors are both story-complete 12ers. They map to each other because they project the same story field through different surfaces.

DRAGI emphasizes relation and movement.

The 12 Actors emphasize actor position and story role.

A useful model can move between the two without treating either as the whole object.

4. Mix equals one

All DRAGI question sets contain both food and signal.

There is no useful split between mixed and unmixed.

mix=1

The live variable is which side carries more force.

A POST may be mostly signal, but it still changes food movement.

A BEEST may be mostly object, but sighting it is also signal.

A PEST may be a problem-object, a no-response state, or small repeated pressure.

A BEST may be an advanced object, a closing foe, or a production reminder to improve the build.

The model gets enough object to act and enough signal to route.

That is likely one reason the internal completion bell rings. The relation has enough dimensions to become usable without demanding a large formal proof.

5. Eating Language and Eating Directions

The system becomes stronger when language and movement remain separate.

Eating Language = permission to move food
Eating Directions = food movement

Permission states can include:

POST	allowed
ROAR	denied by greater force
WAR	contested
WALL	blocked or promised
LAW	held by rule
PEST	no-response or unresolved pressure

Movement states can include:

BEEST	thing at sighting distance
BEST	advanced or closing thing
BAST	thing at striking distance
FAST	strike completed

The two systems cross.

A thing may have permission without movement.

A thing may move without permission.

A language model can use this distinction because it already handles modal language, action language, event sequence, and relation state.

DRAGI gives those capacities a small shared frame.

6. Why BBPB changes in production

In hunt use, BBPB asks what kind of foe stands before the hunter.

BEEST	a thing that may be faced
BEST	a stronger thing, bet on losing
POST	signal, rumor, warning, display
PEST	small, many, persistent pressure

In production use, language models often map the same pulls as:

POST	trace, prior state, signal
PEST	problem needing attention

BEEST object in hand
BEST build or improve next

This is not a corruption of the system.

It is a field translation.

The underlying pulls remain:

what happened
what presses
what is here
what should advance

Because most LLM use is production rather than hunting, the production rendering arrives quickly.

7. Pre and post questions route ecology

A surface word invites dictionary behavior.

Pre and post questions prevent that.

They ask what came before, what comes after, what this eats, what eats it, where it lives, and who carries it.

The slot becomes ecological.

POST trace in a chain
PEST pressure in a system
BEEST live object in relation
BEST next viable build state

This is why DRAGI can work with odd words and still produce useful maps.

The words are handles.

The route carries the object.

8. Morphology helps human and machine memory

Eating Language uses compact forms whose internal letters carry aspects.

Examples include:

FAX FOX FUX
FABX FOBX FUBX

The machine-facing forms use unusual four-letter groups to reduce collisions.

The human-facing forms preserve sound, play, rhythm, and story.

A parser can detect repeated family and changed phase without needing a separate name for every case.

The morphology can encode:

family
phase
aspect
direction
permission

This makes new forms discoverable rather than merely memorable.

9. Story completeness fits language models

Language models are trained on stories, explanations, dialogue, instructions, reports, myths, code, and arguments.

Across those forms, they repeatedly encounter:

actors
objects
places
goals
pressure
sequence
permission
consequence
witness

DRAGI does not require a model to learn a foreign symbolic world from zero.

It gives compact handles to relations already present in language.

Research on structured prompting, semantic parsing, retrieval, and tool use supports the general principle that explicit intermediate structure can improve routing and reasoning when the structure remains tied to the task object.[1][2][3][4]

DRAGI adds a human memory advantage. Its structure can be carried through poems, creature names, jokes, tables, and production prompts without losing the underlying relation set.

10. Why it feels easier than formal logic

Formal systems often demand that the user translate a live object into a rigid representation before reasoning begins.

DRAGI allows the object to remain story-shaped.

The user can ask:

what is it called
where does it live
what does it eat
what eats it

Then the deeper map can emerge.

This preserves ambiguity long enough to use it.

Controlled hypotheses can remain hypotheses.

Labels do not have to become the object.

The method is formal enough to route and loose enough to continue the hunt.

11. Failure modes

DRAGI can still fail.

Common failures include:

- surface-word fixation
- pretty rhyme mistaken for structure
- forced 12-matching
- question and answer promoted into non-eating axes
- actor labels treated as powers
- permission confused with movement
- production rendering mistaken for hunt canon

The repair is relation-first testing.

A candidate survives only if it preserves the directional pull across unrelated stories and translates without large residue.

12. Tests

Test 1: Same task, free prose versus DRAGI

Give the same archive or story task to the same model.

Compare:

- object retention
- route fidelity
- source retrieval
- unmapped residue
- false completion

Test 2: Hunt versus production

Run the same BBPB set in a foe-classification task and a build task.

Check whether the model preserves the relational pulls while changing the surface interpretation.

Test 3: Pre and post removal

Remove ecological questions.

Measure whether the model falls back to dictionary meaning or vibe-fit.

Test 4: Morphology collision

Compare ordinary labels with FABX, FOBX, and FUBX.

Measure accidental collisions, retrieval misses, and namespace drift.

Test 5: Cross-story translation

Map unrelated stories through DRAGI and the 12 Actors.

Track every forced placement and every surviving relation.

13. Conclusion

DRAGI works easily with LLMs because it is not merely a prompt format.

It is a compact relation field.

It carries object and signal together.

It separates permission from movement.

It gives models enough structure to route while preserving enough ambiguity to explore.

Its machine forms reduce collision.

Its human forms preserve memory and play.

Its production rendering matches how LLMs are commonly used.

The shortest statement is:

DRAGI works because story is already inside the model,
and DRAGI gives story a small usable routing body.

References

1. Yao, Shunyu, et al. "ReAct: Synergizing Reasoning and Acting in Language Models." ICLR, 2023.
2. Lewis, Patrick, et al. "Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Knowledge-Intensive NLP Tasks." NeurIPS, 2020.
3. Schick, Timo, et al. "Toolformer: Language Models Can Teach Themselves to Use Tools." NeurIPS, 2023.
4. An, Kai, et al. "Enhancing LLM Performance with Semantic Hints." ACL, 2025.
5. etamew / decofan. DRAGI, Eating Language, Eating Directions, Beest poem, BBPB, 12 Actors, and D12 working corpus, 2010-2026.
6. etamew / decofan. "8 flavours of D12 map compressing fast find and fetch." Public release materials, 2026.